



While the Beats Pill is a mono speaker, you can elevate the experience to stereo sound by pairing two Pills in Stereo Mode. Although this requires purchasing a second speaker, it's a nice option to have. For louder playback, you can use Amplify Mode to connect two Beats Pill speakers and boost the volume. One notable omission is multipoint connectivity, a feature that is becoming increasingly essential for users with multiple devices.

PERFORMANCE

The Beats Pill stands out from other portable speakers by forgoing passive bass radiators and instead relying on its internal drivers to deliver its sound. Despite its compact size, the Pill manages to pack a decent bass punch. While it lacks an adjustable EQ, its out-of-the-box sound quality outshines many competitors in its price range, like the JBL Flip 6, and the sound matches the quality of the Bose SoundLink Flex.

The Beats Pill features a racetrack-style neodymium woofer paired with a single neodymium tweeter. Beats hasn't provided official frequency range specifications. The drivers are positioned at a 20-degree upward angle. This new arrangement enhances air displacement, contributing to its improved sound performance. The speaker supports Bluetooth 5.3 and is compatible with both AAC and SBC codecs. However, it lacks support for aptX and other Android-optimised codecs, which is a shame.

On tracks with heavy bass, the Pill provides solid low-frequency response but there is slight distortion at maximum volume. It has a punchy mid-bass that enhances the overall listening experience. Its mid-range reproduction is one of the best at this price with excellent clarity and detail. The Pill delivers a balanced performance with rich sound, allowing vocals and high-frequency elements to shine, while maintaining a full-bodied sound.

The Pill's newly engineered woofer system helps boost its bass and overall sound clarity. While it doesn't reach the depths of larger speakers, it does a commendable job for its size, especially in genres like hip-hop and EDM. However, the treble range can sometimes sound too sharp, particularly with cymbals and high-frequency elements. This is where the absence of an EQ is felt the most, as it limits customisation.

Overall, the Beats Pill is a solid option for those seeking a portable speaker with good sound quality, although its mono output and lack of customisation features might leave some audiophiles wanting more.

BATTERY LIFE

The Pill boasts a battery life of up to 24 hours, though actual performance may vary depending on the volume at which you listen to music. At 50% volume, the speaker lasted for 21 hours and 45 minutes, which is excellent. Furthermore, there's fast charging support too, so a quick 10-minute top-up will net

you 2 hours' worth of playback time. The speaker also charges to full from an empty battery in about 2 hours and 30 minutes, but you need to have a 45 W PD charger to get those speeds. Additionally, you can reverse charge smaller devices via the speaker using USB-C.

VERDICT

The Beats Pill offers a compact and portable audio experience that packs just the right punch for its size. With its race-track-style woofer, the Pill delivers solid bass, complemented by crisp mids and decent highs, making it ideal for casual listeners who enjoy a balanced sound signature. While it lacks features like an adjustable EQ and multipoint connectivity, the speaker's seamless integration with both iOS and Android ecosystems is a major plus, allowing users to locate and manage the device easily. At ₹16,900, the Pill competes well in its segment, though audiophiles might seek more customisation options. For those looking for a sturdy, stylish speaker with decent sound quality and portability, the Beats Pill delivers a satisfying dose of audio.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Speaker setup: Woofer + Tweeter | Form Factor: portable speaker | Length: 8.6 in | Width: 2.8 in | Height: 2.8 in | Weight: 680 g | Battery Life: 24 hours | Fast Charge: Yes, 10 minutes for 2 hours | App: Beats app | IP Rating: IP67

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